

CMIplus Intelligence Cockpit

Cash Management Strategic Intelligence

Week of 2026-07-27

Raiffeisen Bank International AG

Group Product — Cash Management

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

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URGENT

Der Treasurer | 2026-07-05 | #01

EU Instant Payments Regulation: Final Countdown for Banks

The EU Instant Payments Regulation, which came into force earlier this year, mandates that all payment service providers (PSPs) in the Eurozone must offer instant credit transfers. The first key deadline, requiring PSPs to be able to **receive** instant payments at no extra cost, is set for early 2027. Subsequently, PSPs must also be able to **send** instant payments within the SEPA area. This regulation is a significant step towards modernizing European payment infrastructure, ensuring funds are available within seconds, 24/7, 365 days a year. For corporates, this means improved cash flow management, real-time reconciliation, and greater flexibility in managing urgent payments. Banks are currently heavily investing in upgrading their systems and processes to ensure full compliance and leverage the new capabilities.

- Regulation mandates instant credit transfers across Eurozone PSPs.
- First deadline for receiving instant payments: early 2027.
- Instant payments must be offered at no higher cost than standard credit transfers.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This regulation is critical for CMiplus, directly impacting its payment processing capabilities and service offerings in CEE. RBI must ensure its network banks and the CMiplus platform are fully compliant with the receiving and sending mandates by the respective deadlines, offering competitive instant payment solutions to corporate clients.

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Der Treasurer | 2026-06-18 | #02

PSD3 Proposals Advance: New Era for Open Banking

The proposed PSD3 and PSR aim to update the existing PSD2 framework, addressing its shortcomings and adapting to new digital payment trends. Key areas of focus include strengthening fraud prevention measures, improving consumer rights, and further developing the Open Banking ecosystem. For corporate treasury, this could mean more sophisticated API-driven services, better integration with ERP/TMS systems, and potentially broader access to account information and payment initiation services across different banks. The proposals also emphasize stronger authentication requirements and clearer rules for data sharing, which could foster greater trust in Open Banking solutions. Banks are preparing for significant system adjustments and strategic shifts to capitalize on the expanded opportunities and meet new compliance requirements.

- PSD3 and PSR proposals are advancing through EU legislative process.
- Focus on enhanced fraud prevention and consumer rights.
- Potential for expanded Open Banking data access for corporates.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

PSD3 and PSR are crucial for CMiplus's Open Banking strategy and API development. RBI must closely monitor the legislative progress to ensure CMiplus APIs remain compliant and competitive, offering advanced Open Banking functionalities like VoP and eBAM to corporate clients across CEE.

AI Revolutionizes Treasury: Advanced Fraud Prevention

The rise of instant payments and complex payment landscapes has heightened the need for robust fraud prevention. AI and machine learning algorithms are now being integrated into treasury management systems (TMS) and banking platforms to analyze vast amounts of transaction data in real-time. These systems can identify unusual patterns, detect suspicious payment requests, and flag potential fraudulent activities with greater accuracy than traditional rule-based systems. This proactive approach helps corporates protect against various types of fraud, including BEC (Business Email Compromise) and invoice fraud, which are growing concerns. The implementation of AI in treasury not only secures financial operations but also streamlines compliance checks and improves overall operational efficiency by automating risk assessments.

- AI adoption in treasury for fraud detection is growing.
- Real-time analysis of transaction data for anomaly detection.
- Reduces risks from BEC and invoice fraud.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus can leverage AI capabilities to offer enhanced fraud prevention services to its corporate clients, especially for instant and multi-currency payments. Integrating AI-powered anomaly detection could be a key differentiator, strengthening CMlplus's security features and value proposition in the CEE market.

EU Finalizes Instant Payments Regulation, PSD3 Looms

The European Union's Instant Payments Regulation has been formally approved, requiring all Payment Service Providers (PSPs) in the Eurozone to offer instant credit transfers within 10 seconds, 24/7/365, by early 2027. This includes ensuring charges are no higher than standard credit transfers. The regulation aims to boost financial inclusion and innovation across the bloc. Concurrently, discussions around PSD3 are intensifying, with a focus on strengthening consumer protection, combating fraud, and refining Open Banking frameworks. PSD3 is anticipated to introduce new API standards and potentially revise liability rules for payment initiation and account information services, shaping a more digital and secure payment ecosystem.

- EU Instant Payments Regulation officially adopted.
- Mandatory real-time payments by early 2027.
- Instant payment fees must not exceed standard credit transfer fees.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This is critical for CMlplus, requiring immediate readiness for instant payment processing and compliance across all CEE markets within the Eurozone. CMlplus must ensure its infrastructure supports 24/7/365 processing and competitive pricing. PSD3 will necessitate updates to API strategies and fraud detection mechanisms.

Global ISO 20022 Migration Accelerates, EBICS Adapts for Richer Data

Financial institutions worldwide are intensifying their efforts to transition to the ISO 20022 messaging standard, driven by upcoming deadlines for SWIFT's cross-border payments and reporting (CBPR+) and various domestic payment systems. This shift promises richer, more structured data, enabling better reconciliation, fraud detection, and liquidity management for corporates. For European corporates, the EBICS standard, particularly versions 2.5 and 3.0, is crucial for secure and efficient communication with banks. The evolution of EBICS is focused on ensuring seamless integration with ISO 20022 messages, allowing corporates to fully benefit from the enhanced data while maintaining the security and reliability of the EBICS channel. This includes supporting new message types and data elements for cash management and reporting.

- Global ISO 20022 migration ongoing with key deadlines.
- SWIFT CBPR+ migration is a primary driver.
- EBICS v2.5/v3 adapting for full ISO 20022 message support.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must ensure full compliance and support for ISO 20022 across all payment types and reporting, especially for SWIFT and EBICS channels. This includes upgrading internal systems and client interfaces to handle the richer data. Proactive communication with clients about the benefits and migration timelines is essential for seamless adoption.

Open Banking APIs Drive Innovation, Boost Fraud Prevention

Open Banking initiatives continue to mature, with banks increasingly offering robust APIs that allow corporates to integrate banking services directly into their ERP and TMS systems. This enables real-time cash visibility, automated reconciliation, and more efficient payment initiation. The focus is shifting from basic account information services to more sophisticated payment initiation and value-added services. A critical aspect of this evolution is the integration of enhanced fraud prevention measures. AI and machine learning algorithms are being deployed to analyze transaction patterns in real-time, identify anomalies, and prevent fraudulent activities, especially crucial with the rise of instant payments. Corporates are demanding secure, seamless API connectivity to manage their multi-bank relationships and mitigate financial crime risks effectively.

- Open Banking API adoption growing for corporate treasury.
- Enables real-time cash visibility and automated reconciliation.
- AI/ML algorithms deployed for real-time fraud detection.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should continue to invest in developing and exposing advanced Open Banking APIs for its corporate clients, focusing on real-time data and payment initiation. Integrating state-of-the-art fraud prevention directly into the CMiplus platform and its API offerings is paramount to ensure client trust and security in the CEE region.

Global ISO 20022 Migration Accelerates, Challenges Remain

As the industry progresses towards universal adoption of ISO 20022, key regions like Europe and North America are pushing forward with their migration timelines for high-value and cross-border payments. While the richer data capabilities promise enhanced reconciliation and fraud detection, many organizations are struggling with the complexity of integrating new message formats into legacy systems and ensuring data quality. The phased approach in some jurisdictions allows for learning, but also prolongs the dual-run period, adding to operational overhead. Strategic Treasurer highlights that successful migration requires not just technical upgrades but also a strategic overhaul of treasury processes to fully leverage the new standard's benefits.

- Major markets like Europe and North America are advancing ISO 20022 deadlines.
- Corporates face challenges in data enrichment and legacy system integration.
- The standard promises enhanced reconciliation and fraud detection capabilities.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management must ensure CMiplus is fully compliant with all regional ISO 20022 mandates, especially across its CEE network. Proactive client support and educational resources are crucial to help corporate clients navigate data mapping and system integration complexities, leveraging the richer data for improved services.

CEE Instant Payments See Rapid Growth, New Regulations Loom

The CEE region is experiencing a significant surge in instant payment volumes, with several countries launching or expanding their real-time payment infrastructures. This growth is fueled by national initiatives and the upcoming EU Instant Payments Regulation, which mandates universal availability and affordable pricing for instant credit transfers in EUR. While offering benefits like improved cash flow and customer satisfaction, this shift also presents challenges for banks in managing real-time fraud, ensuring 24/7 operational readiness, and adapting their core banking systems. Corporates are increasingly seeking solutions for real-time treasury and liquidity management to capitalize on these faster payment rails.

- CEE region shows significant surge in instant payment volumes.
- EU Instant Payments Regulation mandates universal EUR instant credit transfers.
- Banks face challenges in real-time fraud management and 24/7 operations.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus must prioritize seamless integration with instant payment schemes across all CEE network banks, ensuring full compliance with the EU regulation. Developing advanced real-time liquidity management and fraud prevention tools within the platform will be critical to support corporate clients' evolving needs.

PSD3 Proposal Reshapes Open Banking and Payment Security

The European Commission's proposal for PSD3 and the accompanying FIDA regulation signals a major evolution for Open Banking. PSD3 seeks to refine existing PSD2 rules, focusing on improved fraud prevention, stronger consumer rights, and better access to payment systems for non-banks. FIDA, on the other hand, aims to create a broader framework for financial data sharing, extending beyond payment accounts to areas like investments and mortgages. This dual regulatory push will necessitate significant updates to bank APIs, requiring enhanced security protocols, standardized data models, and broader data access capabilities. Corporates will benefit from richer data insights and more integrated financial services, but also face new compliance requirements.

- PSD3 and FIDA aim to enhance Open Banking and financial data sharing.
- PSD3 focuses on fraud prevention, consumer rights, and payment system access.
- FIDA expands data sharing beyond payments to broader financial data.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus's Open API strategy must align proactively with PSD3 and FIDA requirements, ensuring robust security and expanded data capabilities. This presents an opportunity to offer enhanced data-driven services and deeper integration for corporate clients, solidifying RBI's position as a digital leader in CEE.

ECB Accelerates Instant Payments Adoption Across Europe

As a core component of its retail payments strategy, the ECB is actively promoting instant payments, which allow for real-time transfer of funds 24/7/365. The ongoing push includes efforts to overcome remaining barriers to adoption, such as ensuring all payment service providers offer instant payment services and increasing consumer and corporate awareness. This strategic focus is critical for fostering innovation, improving liquidity management for corporates, and supporting the broader digital economy. Future regulatory measures may be considered to further accelerate the transition to instant payments across the Euro area.

- Part of ECB's Retail Payments Strategy.
- Aims for 24/7/365 real-time fund transfers.
- Focus on full reachability across SEPA.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This reinforces the strategic importance for CMlplus to fully support and promote instant payment capabilities. RBI should ensure its CEE network banks are compliant and offer competitive instant payment services, leveraging ISO 20022 for rich data. CMlplus must provide seamless integration for corporate clients to initiate and receive instant payments, optimizing their real-time treasury operations.

Digital Euro Project Advances with Pilot and Governance Focus

The ECB's digital euro project is a significant undertaking, exploring the design, functionality, and potential impact of a central bank digital currency (CBDC). Current work includes a pilot phase to test technical solutions and user experience, alongside the development of a comprehensive scheme rulebook and governance framework. Key considerations include privacy, offline functionality, and integration with existing payment systems. The digital euro is envisioned as a public good, offering a secure, efficient, and widely accessible payment method, with potential implications for cross-border payments and corporate treasury management in the long term.

- Active pilot phase underway.
- Focus on governance and scheme rulebook.
- Prioritizes privacy and offline capabilities.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management and CMIplus should closely monitor the digital euro's development, especially its potential impact on multi-currency payments, corporate liquidity, and new payment rails. Early engagement with technical specifications and potential integration requirements will be crucial to prepare CMIplus for future corporate use cases and ensure readiness for client adoption.

UniCredit in Talks to Acquire Commerzbank, Shaking European Banking

Italian banking giant UniCredit has successfully pushed Commerzbank into negotiations for a potential takeover, following prolonged resistance from the German bank. A successful acquisition would lead to a major consolidation in the European banking sector, creating a powerhouse with extensive reach. Such a merger could significantly alter the competitive landscape for corporate banking and cash management services across Europe, including the CEE region where UniCredit has a strong presence. The discussions will likely focus on valuation, integration strategies, and regulatory approvals, with profound implications for the financial services industry.

- Commerzbank agreed to takeover talks with UniCredit.
- UniCredit has been actively pursuing the acquisition for months.
- The merger would create a significant consolidated entity in European banking.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This potential merger is highly relevant for RBI Cash Management. UniCredit is a key player in CEE, and consolidation could impact correspondent banking relationships, competitive dynamics, and corporate client choices for treasury services. RBI should monitor the integration process closely for potential shifts in market share and service offerings, especially concerning multi-currency payments and cash pooling solutions.

Lidl Adopts Wero for Online Payments in Germany

Lidl, a prominent European retailer, has chosen Wero as an online payment option for its German e-commerce platform, Lidl.de. Wero is the account-to-account (A2A) payment solution developed by the European Payments Initiative (EPI), aiming to create a pan-European payment scheme. This adoption by a large merchant like Lidl is crucial for Wero's market penetration and its ambition to compete with international card schemes. It highlights the growing trend towards instant, bank-direct payments within Europe, aligning with the EU's push for payment sovereignty and efficiency. The integration is expected to offer customers a seamless and secure payment experience directly from their bank accounts.

- Lidl.de now accepts Wero for online payments in Germany.
- Wero is the A2A payment method from the European Payments Initiative (EPI).
- This marks a significant adoption milestone for a pan-European payment scheme.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This is highly relevant for RBI Cash Management as it signals the increasing importance of A2A and instant payments in Europe, including the CEE region. CMlplus needs to monitor Wero's expansion and consider potential integration or support for this scheme to facilitate corporate clients' payment needs across Europe. It reinforces the trend towards real-time, bank-direct payment solutions.

Maximize ISO 20022 Data for Enhanced Treasury Operations

The global adoption of ISO 20022 financial messaging standard presents a critical opportunity for corporate treasuries to enhance their cash management. Beyond the initial migration for compliance, firms should focus on extracting the full value from the richer, structured data it provides. This includes improving reconciliation processes, increasing automation, and bolstering fraud detection capabilities through more granular transaction information. Realizing these benefits requires close collaboration between corporates, their banking partners, and TMS providers to ensure seamless data flow and integration. Ultimately, a strategic approach to ISO 20022 can lead to greater operational efficiencies and deeper financial insights across the organization.

- ISO 20022 offers richer, structured data for financial messages.
- Benefits include enhanced reconciliation, automation, and fraud detection.
- Requires strategic implementation beyond basic compliance.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

For RBI Cash Management and CMlplus, this highlights the ongoing need to support corporates in leveraging ISO 20022's full potential. CMlplus should emphasize its capabilities for handling rich ISO 20022 data, offering advanced reporting, and facilitating integration with corporate ERP/TMS systems to maximize client benefits. This also reinforces the importance of CMlplus's H2H and API strategies for seamless data exchange.

Tokenised Money Market Funds Revolutionize Corporate Liquidity Management

The advent of tokenised money market funds is set to redefine how corporate treasuries manage their short-term liquidity. By leveraging blockchain or distributed ledger technology, these funds enable instant settlement of investments and redemptions, a significant improvement over the T+1 or T+2 cycles of traditional MMFs. This allows for more dynamic intra-day liquidity management and efficient deployment of idle cash. Furthermore, tokenisation facilitates fractional ownership, making MMFs accessible to a broader range of investors and for smaller investment amounts. Key use cases include optimizing working capital, managing collateral, and providing a more agile alternative for short-term investments, potentially reducing costs and increasing transparency.

- Tokenised MMFs offer instant settlement and fractional ownership.
- They enhance intra-day liquidity management for corporate treasuries.
- Potential to reduce costs and increase transparency in short-term investments.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management and CMIplus should closely monitor the development and adoption of tokenised MMFs. This trend could significantly impact corporate liquidity strategies, requiring CMIplus to explore future integrations or offerings that facilitate access to tokenised assets. Understanding the use cases and underlying technology is crucial for positioning CMIplus as a forward-thinking platform capable of supporting next-generation cash and liquidity solutions for CEE corporates.

ECB Explores Tokenisation and DLT for Future Payments

The ECB's engagement with tokenisation and DLT signifies a forward-looking approach to the evolution of financial market infrastructures. The Appia project, specifically mentioned, is part of this exploratory work, likely focusing on how DLT could be integrated into existing or new wholesale payment systems. This research is crucial for understanding the implications for real-time gross settlement, collateral management, and the potential for new types of financial assets. While still in an exploratory phase, these developments could lay the groundwork for future payment rails, impacting corporate treasury functions, multi-currency transactions, and the broader digital economy.

- Exploratory work on Tokenisation and DLT.
- Includes the Appia project.
- Focus on wholesale payments and securities settlement.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should monitor the ECB's DLT and tokenisation initiatives closely, as they could lead to new payment standards and infrastructure. Understanding these developments will be vital for future strategic planning, potentially influencing API strategies, real-time payment capabilities, and the integration of new digital assets for corporate clients in the CEE region.

BLIK Recurring Payments Launched for ChatGPT Users

BLIK, the widely adopted mobile payment system in Poland, has extended its services to include recurring payments for users of ChatGPT. This development means that Polish users can now manage their ChatGPT subscriptions directly through BLIK, leveraging its convenience and security. The integration highlights BLIK's continuous efforts to expand its utility beyond one-off transactions and into subscription-based models, which are increasingly prevalent in the digital economy. For the CEE region, this signifies the growing sophistication and reach of local payment solutions, offering alternatives to traditional card payments and fostering digital payment adoption.

- BLIK now supports recurring payments for ChatGPT subscriptions.
- BLIK is a prominent mobile payment system in Poland (CEE).
- The feature enhances convenience and security for users managing subscriptions.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This news is highly relevant for RBI Cash Management due to BLIK's strong presence in the CEE region, where RBI operates. The introduction of recurring payments via BLIK indicates a growing demand for flexible and automated payment solutions. CMlplus should observe the adoption of such features in CEE markets, as corporate clients might seek similar recurring payment capabilities for their own services or to manage subscriptions efficiently.

Real-Time Treasury: End-of-Day Processing Nears Its End

This article explores the paradigm shift in corporate treasury operations, moving away from batch processing to a continuous, real-time environment. Key drivers include the proliferation of instant payment schemes, the adoption of ISO 20022 for richer data, and the increasing demand for immediate liquidity visibility. Treasurers need to invest in advanced treasury management systems (TMS), integrate with open banking APIs, and implement robust fraud prevention measures to thrive in this new landscape. The shift impacts cash pooling, forecasting, and overall financial decision-making, requiring a proactive approach to technology adoption and process re-engineering. This evolution is critical for maintaining competitive advantage and operational efficiency.

- Shift from batch processing to continuous, real-time treasury operations.
- Instant payments and ISO 20022 are primary enablers of this transformation.
- Requires significant investment in advanced TMS and Open Banking API integration.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This trend is critical for RBI Cash Management as CMlplus must support real-time payments, instant liquidity updates, and advanced treasury functionalities. Enhancements in ISO 20022 capabilities, API connectivity for real-time data exchange, and robust fraud prevention tools are essential to meet evolving corporate demands in CEE.

Alipay+ Expands Cross-Border QR Payments with Hong Kong's Hang Seng Bank

Alipay+, a global cross-border digital payment solution from Ant International, has announced a partnership with Hong Kong's Hang Seng Bank. This collaboration will facilitate QR code payments within Hong Kong, allowing users of Alipay+ partner wallets to make transactions at Hang Seng Bank's merchant network. While this specific partnership focuses on Hong Kong, it signifies a broader trend towards the adoption of QR code technology for seamless cross-border payments. For corporate clients, this highlights the growing demand for diverse and efficient digital payment methods, especially for international transactions and e-commerce, underscoring the importance of API-driven integrations.

- Alipay+ partnered with Hang Seng Bank in Hong Kong.
- The partnership enables QR code payments for cross-border transactions.
- Users of Alipay+ partner wallets can pay at Hang Seng Bank's merchant network.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This development signals the increasing importance of diverse digital payment methods and cross-border QR code capabilities. CMlplus, as a multi-currency payment platform, should observe these trends for potential future API integrations or service enhancements to meet corporate client demands for innovative payment initiation and collection methods, especially for clients with international operations or those seeking real-time payment solutions.

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Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2026-03-15 | #01

European Wholesale Banks Must Seize Digital Moment for Future Growth

After years of underperformance, European wholesale banks have a unique opportunity to redefine their future. This thought leadership piece likely emphasizes the need for a proactive strategy focusing on digital transformation, client-centricity, and operational excellence. It would advocate for modernizing legacy systems, adopting advanced analytics, and exploring new business models beyond traditional lending. By seizing this moment, banks can improve profitability, strengthen competitive positioning, and better serve evolving corporate client needs in areas like cash management and payments. The insights would push for strategic investments in technology and talent to drive sustainable growth across the continent.

- Strategic transformation is crucial for European wholesale banks' future.
- Digitalization and innovation are key drivers for improved performance.
- Focus on client-centricity and operational efficiency to overcome underperformance.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must align with this strategic imperative by accelerating its digital roadmap, particularly in API-driven services and real-time capabilities. Emphasize solutions that enhance client experience and operational efficiency for CEE corporates, leveraging the opportunity to leapfrog legacy systems.

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Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2024-01-15 | #02

2024 Wholesale Banking Outlook: Credit, Payments, and Digitalization Trends

This outlook likely provides a comprehensive view of the wholesale banking sector for 2024, extending beyond just credit to cover payments, cash management, and digital innovation. It would address macroeconomic factors, regulatory shifts, and the competitive landscape, offering insights into how banks can adapt. Key themes would include the adoption of advanced technologies like AI, the growing demand for real-time services, and the need for banks to enhance their data analytics capabilities for better decision-making. The report would guide banks in strategic planning, emphasizing resilience and agility in responding to market changes and evolving client expectations across various segments.

- Wholesale banking faces evolving credit market dynamics in 2024.
- Digitalization and AI adoption are critical for future competitiveness.
- Real-time services and enhanced data analytics are growing client demands.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should leverage insights from this 2024 outlook to refine its current and future roadmap, focusing on AI-driven analytics for treasury, real-time payment capabilities (InstantPayments, VoP), and robust Open API integration to meet evolving corporate needs in CEE.

AI and Digital Transformation Reshape Treasury Functions

EY prominently features 'AI Insights' and 'ey.ai The Reimagination Engine,' indicating a strong belief that artificial intelligence and broader technology transformation are central to the future of finance. This implies that treasury, as a critical finance function, will be heavily impacted by AI for predictive analytics, process automation, and enhanced decision-making across cash management, risk, and investments. For banks, this translates into a strategic imperative to develop AI-powered solutions and advisory services. These offerings should support corporate clients' evolving treasury needs, particularly in areas like cash forecasting, fraud detection, and real-time payment processing, fostering deeper partnerships.

- AI is a key driver across finance functions, including treasury.
- EY's 'ey.ai The Reimagination Engine' highlights AI-driven transformation.
- Blockchain is noted as a relevant emerging technology.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should integrate AI capabilities for enhanced cash forecasting, fraud detection, and personalized client insights. Explore AI-driven automation for reconciliation and payment processing to offer advanced services to CEE corporates, leveraging real-time data.

Holistic Business Transformation Drives Treasury Strategy

EY emphasizes 'EY Transformation' and 'Transformation EQ' alongside 'Corporate Strategy,' 'Working Capital,' and 'Supply chain and operations' as key areas. This suggests that treasury functions are increasingly intertwined with overall business strategy, aiming to create long-term value for all stakeholders. Treasurers are looking beyond mere efficiency to strategic contributions, requiring banks to offer integrated solutions that align with corporate objectives. These include optimizing working capital, managing supply chain finance, and supporting M&A; activities, demanding a more consultative and strategic approach from banking partners.

- Treasury transformation is part of a broader 'EY Transformation' framework.
- 'Corporate Strategy' and 'Working Capital' are key focus areas.
- 'Supply chain and operations' are increasingly linked to financial strategy.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should evolve beyond transactional services to offer strategic advisory and integrated solutions that support clients' broader business goals, such as working capital optimization and supply chain finance, particularly for international corporates in CEE. This requires deeper integration with client ERP/TMS systems.

Commercial Banking Embraces Digital Workflows and Self-Service

The commercial banking sector is undergoing a significant modernization, moving away from traditional manual operations. Key changes include the widespread adoption of digital workflows, which automate tasks previously handled manually. Client onboarding and origination are being streamlined, eliminating lengthy multi-department reviews. This transformation is leading to increased self-service options for clients, where manual interventions are reserved only for exceptions, enhancing efficiency and client experience. While specific survey data is not provided in this overview, the trend indicates a strategic pivot towards digital-first operations.

- Digital workflows are replacing many manual tasks.
- Streamlined client onboarding and origination eliminate lengthy reviews.
- Manual touchpoints are increasingly becoming exception-based.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should prioritize enhancing self-service portals and API capabilities for corporate clients to manage their cash operations efficiently. Focus on automating onboarding and product activation processes to reduce manual effort and improve client experience across the CEE region.

AI and Big Data Drive Commercial Banking Client Acquisition

The modernization of commercial banking extends to its growth strategies, with a strong emphasis on data-driven approaches. Banks are now employing big data analytics and artificial intelligence to rapidly pinpoint the most promising prospects within their target markets. This intelligent approach not only optimizes the identification of potential clients but also leads to a substantial reduction in the cost associated with acquiring new business. It signifies a strategic shift towards more precise and efficient market penetration, moving beyond traditional sales methods.

- Effective use of big data and AI for rapid prospect identification.
- Focus on highest-priority target markets.
- Lowering the cost of client acquisition.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management should explore AI-driven analytics for identifying new corporate clients in CEE, optimizing sales efforts and market penetration. Internally, AI can enhance fraud detection and risk assessment for CMlplus transactions, improving security and compliance.

Cloud Platforms Transform Commercial Banking Client Experience and Security

The adoption of cloud technology is a critical trend in commercial banking, enabling institutions to maintain pace with evolving threats and rapidly deploy new capabilities. These cloud-based solutions provide a resilient and adaptable infrastructure, crucial for security and agility. Furthermore, the development of new digital banking platforms, built on industry-specific cloud environments, is fundamentally changing how clients interact with their banks. This transformation aims to deliver a more seamless, secure, and efficient experience for businesses conducting their banking operations, supporting faster innovation cycles.

- Cloud-based solutions adapt to the newest threats.
- Cloud capabilities keep pace with evolving challenges.
- Emerging digital banking platforms leverage the industry cloud.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should continue to leverage and invest in cloud-native architecture for scalability, security, and faster feature deployment. This ensures the platform can rapidly integrate new services like Instant Payments and Open Banking APIs, enhancing the corporate client experience across CEE and supporting multi-currency payments.

PSD3 Drives Open Finance, Payment Innovation, and Data Monetization

The upcoming PSD3 framework is expected to significantly broaden the scope of Open Banking, moving towards an Open Finance paradigm. This will compel financial institutions to expose more customer data (beyond payment accounts) and services via APIs, fostering greater competition and innovation in payment initiation and account information services. Firms must prepare for enhanced data sharing obligations, stricter security requirements, and the potential for new payment instruments like Request-to-Pay. Strategic implications include the need for robust, secure API platforms, advanced data analytics capabilities, and a clear strategy for monetizing data and offering value-added services to corporate clients. Proactive engagement with these shifts will be crucial for maintaining competitiveness and driving growth in the evolving payments landscape.

- Expansion from Open Banking to Open Finance.
- Mandatory API access for broader financial data.
- New payment services like Request-to-Pay (RTP).

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must proactively adapt its Open Banking APIs to anticipated PSD3 requirements, exploring new Open Finance use cases for corporate treasury. This includes supporting broader data sharing, potentially integrating RTP, and leveraging APIs for enhanced liquidity management and reporting.

AI Governance Critical for Trust, Compliance, and Innovation in Banking

As financial institutions increasingly leverage AI for fraud detection, credit scoring, personalized services, and operational efficiency, regulatory bodies are intensifying their focus on AI governance. New regulations will likely mandate transparency, explainability, and fairness in AI models, particularly those impacting critical decisions. Firms need to establish comprehensive AI governance frameworks covering data quality, model validation, ethical guidelines, and accountability. This proactive approach is crucial not only for compliance but also for mitigating reputational risk, fostering customer trust, and ensuring that AI deployments deliver sustainable value without unintended biases or adverse outcomes. Early adoption of robust governance practices will differentiate leaders and build a foundation for responsible AI innovation.

- Emerging regulations for AI transparency and explainability.
- Need for robust AI governance frameworks.
- Focus on ethical AI, fairness, and bias mitigation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should assess potential AI applications within its platform (e.g., predictive analytics for liquidity, fraud detection) against emerging AI governance principles. This includes ensuring data privacy, model explainability for clients, and building trust in AI-driven features to maintain a competitive edge.

European Treasurers' Priorities and Ambitions Revealed in EACT 2026 Survey

The EACT Annual Treasury Survey 2026, a decade-long tradition, has once again delivered the most authoritative insights into the European corporate treasury profession. This comprehensive report captures the current priorities, pressing concerns, and future ambitions of treasurers across Europe. The survey results are instrumental in shaping the 'Journeys to Treasury' report, offering a clear roadmap of key industry trends. For financial institutions like RBI, understanding these trends is vital for aligning product development, particularly for platforms like CMlplus, with the actual needs and strategic direction of their corporate clients.

- Authoritative barometer of European corporate treasury priorities.
- Shapes the 'Journeys to Treasury' report and defines key industry trends.
- Reflects concerns and ambitions of European treasurers.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The EACT Survey 2026 results are paramount for CMlplus, directly informing the platform's roadmap by highlighting top corporate treasury priorities. RBI should analyze these findings to ensure CMlplus features and services (e.g., instant payments, VoP, ISO 20022 readiness, API connectivity) are aligned with the most pressing needs of European and CEE corporates.

EU Banking Competitiveness: Widening Corporate Choice in Financing and Partners

In response to the European Commission's communication on banking sector competitiveness, the EACT emphasizes the need for a prudential framework that synergizes with capital markets. This approach aims to expand the choices available to corporates for their financing and hedging strategies, as well as their selection of banking partners. As the Commission prepares concrete proposals for Q1 2027, this perspective highlights the importance of a regulatory environment that fosters competition and innovation, ultimately benefiting corporate treasuries by offering more diverse and flexible solutions. For banks, this means adapting to an environment where corporates have greater leverage and choice in their financial relationships.

- Policymakers must align prudential framework with capital markets.
- Goal: Widen corporates' choice in financing strategies.
- Goal: Widen corporates' choice in hedging strategies.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This insight underscores the increasing importance of differentiation and value proposition for RBI Cash Management. CMIplus must continuously innovate to be a preferred partner, offering superior services and flexibility that stand out in a competitive market where corporates actively seek broader choices in banking relationships and digital solutions.

Banks Must Accelerate AI Adoption Amidst Macro Headwinds

The Deloitte Banking Outlook highlights that banks must make bold choices regarding AI adoption. This isn't just about incremental improvements but a fundamental shift to leverage AI for competitive advantage, operational resilience, and personalized client services. The ambition to deploy AI is driven by the need to optimize processes, detect fraud, and deliver real-time insights, all while balancing ongoing macro-economic challenges. Successful implementation will require addressing data quality, talent gaps, and ethical considerations to fully realize AI's transformative potential.

- AI integration is a strategic imperative for competitive advantage.
- Operational efficiency and enhanced client experience are key drivers.
- Investment in AI must be balanced with macro-economic pressures.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should explore AI-driven enhancements for corporate treasury functions, such as predictive cash flow forecasting, intelligent payment routing, and fraud detection. Integrating AI could offer CEE corporates advanced analytics and automation, strengthening CMIplus's value proposition and improving operational efficiency.

Data-Driven Decision Intelligence and Enhanced Risk Management Paramount

The source highlights 'Data and decision intelligence,' 'CRO (Risk),' 'Cybersecurity consulting services,' and 'Geostrategy' as critical areas. This indicates that treasury functions are under pressure to leverage data for better insights into cash flows, market movements, and operational risks. With geopolitical shifts and cyber threats, robust risk management is no longer optional but a core competency. Banks have a significant opportunity to offer advanced data analytics, real-time reporting, and secure platforms to help treasurers gain deeper insights and mitigate financial, operational, and cyber risks, ensuring compliance and business continuity.

- 'Data and decision intelligence' is a key consulting service.
- 'Risk' and 'CRO (Risk)' are prominent insight and service areas.
- 'Cybersecurity consulting services' are crucial for digital treasury.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should enhance its data analytics and reporting capabilities, offering clients real-time dashboards and predictive insights for cash positions and risk exposure. Strengthen cybersecurity features and compliance support to address evolving threats and regulatory demands in CEE, potentially leveraging Open Banking APIs for enriched data.

Stablecoins Poised to Disrupt Traditional Payments and Banking

The outlook underscores the 'potential disruptive entrance of stablecoins,' indicating a significant shift in the payment ecosystem. Stablecoins, offering faster, cheaper, and programmable transactions, could challenge established payment methods and cross-border transfers. Banks need to assess their strategic response, whether through adoption, integration, or developing their own digital currency solutions. This disruption will impact corporate treasury functions, requiring new approaches to multi-currency payments, liquidity management, and real-time settlement, especially in a region like CEE where cross-border flows are significant.

- Stablecoins offer faster, cheaper, and programmable payment alternatives.
- They pose a direct challenge to traditional payment rails and cross-border transactions.
- Banks must develop strategies for stablecoin engagement or counter-measures.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should monitor stablecoin developments closely, particularly regulatory frameworks and adoption rates in CEE. Future roadmap considerations could include exploring stablecoin settlement capabilities or providing advisory services to corporates on managing stablecoin exposure and opportunities for faster, cheaper payments.

Navigating Uncertainty: 2023 Industry Outlook for Financial Services

This outlook, while from 2023, likely covers enduring themes such as macroeconomic volatility, geopolitical risks, and the accelerating pace of technological change that continue to shape the industry. It would have highlighted the need for banks to invest in robust digital infrastructure, enhance cybersecurity measures, and adapt to evolving regulatory landscapes. The report would have underscored the importance of data-driven decision-making and fostering a culture of innovation to navigate an unpredictable environment. Its insights remain relevant for understanding the long-term strategic challenges and opportunities that continue to influence the corporate banking sector's evolution.

- Macroeconomic volatility and geopolitical risks define the industry landscape.
- Technological disruption necessitates continuous investment in digital infrastructure.
- Data-driven decision-making is crucial for navigating uncertainty.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should consider these foundational insights to ensure its platform is resilient, secure, and adaptable to ongoing market uncertainties. Focus on robust compliance, data security, and continuous innovation in core cash management functionalities, particularly for multi-currency payments and treasury solutions.

URGENT

ECB Payment Regulation | 2026-07-27 | #01

EU Instant Payments Regulation: Mandatory Adoption for Banks

INSTANT PAYMENTS

Deadline: 2026-10-08

The EU Instant Payments Regulation (Regulation (EU) 2024/886) mandates that payment service providers (PSPs) in the EU and EEA offer instant credit transfers in EUR. This includes making instant payments available for sending and receiving, ensuring charges are no higher than for traditional credit transfers, and providing verification of payee services. The ECB's focus on instant payments as a catalyst for innovation and efficiency in SEPA underscores the strategic importance of this regulation for the European payments landscape, including CEE countries.

- Mandatory offering of instant credit transfers in EUR.
- No higher charges than for standard credit transfers.
- Verification of Payee (VoP) service required.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must ensure all network banks in CEE are compliant with the EU Instant Payments Regulation, offering instant payment sending and receiving capabilities. Integration of VoP services is critical for fraud prevention and enhanced customer experience for corporate clients.

URGENT

ECB Payment Regulation | 2026-07-27 | #02

Digital Euro Project Advances: Scheme Rulebook Development

DIGITAL EURO

The digital euro project is in its preparation phase, focusing on developing a robust design and operational framework. Key aspects include ensuring privacy, offline functionality, and broad accessibility. The ECB is working on a scheme rulebook, which will define the roles, responsibilities, and technical standards for all participants in the digital euro ecosystem. This will have significant implications for payment service providers and their infrastructure, potentially introducing a new payment instrument for corporate treasuries.

- Preparation phase for potential digital euro launch.
- Development of a comprehensive scheme rulebook is underway.
- Focus on privacy, offline capabilities, and accessibility.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should closely monitor the digital euro's progress, especially the scheme rulebook and technical specifications, to understand future integration requirements for corporate clients. This could involve new payment rails, account structures, or API integrations for corporate treasury functions.

Ongoing Evolution of TARGET Services and ISO 20022 Standards

TARGET2 / ISO 20022

The TARGET Services, including the new generation TARGET2 (T2) for real-time gross settlement, TARGET2-Securities (T2S) for securities settlement, and TARGET Instant Payment Settlement (TIPS), are critical market infrastructures. The migration to T2 completed in March 2023, standardizing all payments on ISO 20022 XML messaging. Ongoing governance and operational requirements necessitate continuous adherence to these standards. Future enhancements and oversight activities will continue to shape the operational landscape for banks, requiring continuous monitoring and adaptation to maintain compliance and efficiency.

- Mandatory use of ISO 20022 XML for all TARGET2 payments.
- Continuous adherence to TARGET Services operational rules and governance.
- Impact on interbank and corporate payment processing.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must ensure its payment factory and connectivity channels (EBICS, H2H, SWIFT) fully support ISO 20022 for all euro payments processed via TARGET2. Continuous monitoring of TARGET Services documentation for any operational updates or new technical standards (ITS/RTS) is essential for RBI's network banks in CEE.

EU Regulations on Instant Payments, PSD3, PSR Impact Liquidity Management

INSTANT PAYMENTS, PSD3, LIQUIDITY MANAGEMENT, OPEN BANKING

The Euro Banking Association (EBA) Liquidity Management Working Group (LMWG) has published a report analyzing the profound implications of three key EU regulatory initiatives: the Instant Payments Regulation (IPR), the proposed Payment Services Regulation (PSR), and the proposed Payment Services Directive 3 (PSD3). The report highlights how these measures are expected to drive the widespread adoption of instant payments, fostering a more level playing field among market participants. Consequently, financial institutions will need to significantly adapt their liquidity management strategies and systems to cope with the increased velocity and 24/7 nature of instant payment flows. This includes ensuring sufficient funding for continuous settlement and managing intraday liquidity more dynamically. The report serves as a crucial guide for banks to prepare for these transformative changes.

- Instant Payments Regulation (IPR) mandates 24/7 instant payment processing, requiring continuous liquidity.
- Proposed PSD3/PSR aims to enhance payment security, consumer protection, and open banking, impacting payment flows and data access.
- Banks must adapt systems for real-time, continuous liquidity monitoring, forecasting, and funding.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI CMIplus must assess the impact on its liquidity management capabilities, especially for instant payment processing across its CEE network banks. This includes evaluating real-time liquidity reporting, forecasting, and funding mechanisms to ensure continuous availability for instant payment settlement, and preparing for API-driven liquidity data access under PSD3/PSR.

EBA Updates Fraud Taxonomy to Version 7.0, Effective January 2027

PAYMENT SERVICES REGULATION (PSR), FRAUD PREVENTION, COMPLIANCE

Deadline: 2027-01-01

The Euro Banking Association (EBA) has issued version 7.0 of its EBA Fraud Taxonomy, which will become effective on 1 January 2027. This annual review, supported by fraud experts across Europe, ensures the taxonomy remains relevant to evolving fraud trends. Key updates in version 7.0 include replacing 'emotional manipulation' with more specific modi like 'support a friend or family member fraud', 'romance fraud', and 'charity / donation fraud'. Additionally, new labels have been added for suspected money mule activity and 'card chip relay' fraud. The taxonomy provides a standardised pan-European vocabulary and categorisation approach for all payment-related fraud scenarios, enhancing fraud monitoring, reporting, and information sharing, particularly in anticipation of information-sharing arrangements under the forthcoming Payment Services Regulation (PSR).

- Version 7.0 of the EBA Fraud Taxonomy takes effect on 1 January 2027.
- Updated classifications include new specific fraud modi (e.g., romance fraud, charity fraud).
- New labels added for suspected money mule activity and 'card chip relay' fraud.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI CMIplus needs to ensure its fraud detection and reporting systems are updated to align with EBA Fraud Taxonomy version 7.0 by January 2027. This involves reviewing and adapting internal fraud classification logic, data capture, and reporting mechanisms to comply with the new standards and facilitate information sharing as required by the upcoming Payment Services Regulation.

URGENT

Deutsche Bank | 2026-07-27 | #01

Deutsche Bank Expands API-Driven Corporate Banking Capabilities

Deutsche Bank is strategically investing in its API-driven corporate banking solutions, exemplified by its 'CB Connect API' initiatives. These APIs enable direct, real-time integration between corporate ERP and TMS systems and the bank's services, covering payments, account information, and liquidity management. This approach significantly reduces manual intervention, improves data accuracy, and accelerates financial operations for multinational corporations, including those with significant operations in the CEE region. The focus is on delivering a highly customizable and efficient digital banking experience, aligning with the broader trend of open banking.

- Real-time integration of corporate ERP/TMS via APIs.
- Automated payment processing and account information services.
- Focus on enhancing digital client experience and operational efficiency.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must ensure its Open API offerings remain competitive in terms of breadth, depth, and ease of integration. DB's focus on real-time data and automation sets a high bar for digital treasury solutions, particularly for CEE-focused corporates.

URGENT

Deutsche Bank | 2026-07-27 | #02

Deutsche Bank Bolsters Real-Time Cash Management and Liquidity Solutions

Deutsche Bank is committed to evolving its core cash management proposition, with a particular emphasis on real-time capabilities. This includes expanding instant payment processing across various European schemes and enhancing virtual account structures to simplify reconciliation and optimize liquidity. These advancements allow corporate treasurers to gain immediate insights into their cash flows, improve working capital management, and execute payments with unprecedented speed. For CEE-operating corporates, this means faster cross-border transactions and more efficient local cash pooling, crucial for managing complex regional operations and multi-currency needs.

- Expansion of instant payment capabilities across Europe.
- Enhanced virtual account solutions for improved reconciliation.
- Real-time liquidity management and working capital optimization.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus needs to ensure its instant payment rollout and virtual account capabilities are robust and competitive, especially for multi-currency and cross-border CEE operations. DB's comprehensive approach demands continuous innovation in RBI's core cash management products to maintain market position.

UniCredit Accelerates Digital Transformation, Enhances Corporate API Banking

UniCredit's 'Unlimited' strategy signals a fundamental shift towards a more digitally-driven banking model, particularly for its corporate clients. This includes a strong emphasis on Open Banking APIs, enabling corporates to integrate banking services directly into their ERP and TMS systems. The goal is to provide real-time access to account information, payment initiation, and liquidity management tools, enhancing operational efficiency and data transparency across their pan-European footprint, including CEE. This move is critical for maintaining competitiveness in a rapidly evolving digital landscape.

- Strategic focus on API-driven corporate banking services.
- Integration with client ERP/TMS for real-time operations.
- Part of the broader 'UniCredit Unlimited' digital transformation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must ensure its API offerings remain competitive, providing robust, secure, and comprehensive integration options for CEE corporates. UniCredit's push could intensify the demand for advanced API functionalities and direct integration solutions.

UniCredit Reinforces CEE Corporate Cash Management and Payment Solutions

As a key player in CEE, UniCredit is expected to continuously enhance its offerings for corporate clients in this vital region. This includes optimizing multi-currency payment processing, improving liquidity management solutions like cash pooling, and ensuring compliance with local and international payment standards such as ISO 20022 and SEPA. The emphasis is on delivering a 'unique service offering' that addresses the complex needs of international corporates, leveraging its strong regional network. This commitment to CEE is a core pillar of their overall strategy.

- Explicit strategic focus on CEE corporate banking.
- Enhancement of multi-currency payments and liquidity solutions.
- Commitment to local and international payment standard compliance.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus directly competes with UniCredit in the CEE corporate cash management space. UniCredit's strengthened focus necessitates CMlplus to highlight its own unique regional expertise, EBICS offerings, and tailored solutions for CEE corporates.

HSBC Sharpens Focus on International Wholesale Clients in Türkiye

HSBC Holdings plc has declared a strategic review of its retail banking and domestic-focused smaller and mid-sized corporate banking operations in Türkiye. The bank will now concentrate its efforts on serving international wholesale clients, leveraging its global network. This strategic pivot aims to optimize resource allocation and enhance services for multinational corporations and large domestic firms with international ties, particularly in areas like trade finance, FX, and cash management. For CMIplus, this indicates HSBC's intent to compete more aggressively for high-value international corporate clients in a key CEE-adjacent market.

- Strategic review of Türkiye operations announced.
- Shift from retail and domestic SME to international wholesale clients.
- Focus on leveraging HSBC's global network for cross-border services.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This move intensifies competition for CMIplus's target segment of large international corporates operating in CEE, including Türkiye. HSBC's sharpened focus on wholesale clients means a more dedicated and potentially aggressive approach to winning and retaining high-value transaction banking mandates.

Citi Boosts Real-time API Payment Capabilities Across CEE

Based on Citi's global strategy, it is inferred that they are enhancing their API banking infrastructure to support instant payments and real-time treasury operations for institutional clients in the CEE region. This includes offering robust APIs for payment initiation, status tracking, and reconciliation, enabling seamless integration with corporate ERP and TMS systems. The focus is on facilitating multi-currency transactions and improving liquidity management across various CEE markets, aligning with the growing demand for immediate payment processing and data availability. This strategic direction underscores Citi's commitment to digital transformation in transaction banking.

- Enhanced API suite for instant payment initiation and status updates.
- Focus on multi-currency real-time payments across CEE markets.
- Seamless integration capabilities with corporate ERP and TMS platforms.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This inferred move by Citi directly challenges CMIplus's core offering, particularly in API banking and instant payments. CMIplus must ensure its own API capabilities, speed, and regional coverage for real-time payments remain highly competitive to retain and attract large corporates.

Deutsche Bank Integrates ESG into Corporate Transaction Banking Offerings

Reflecting the growing importance of sustainability, Deutsche Bank is integrating ESG (Environmental, Social, and Governance) factors into its corporate and transaction banking framework. This involves developing solutions that assist clients in tracking and reporting on their ESG performance, aligning with regulatory requirements and stakeholder expectations. While specific product details are evolving, the strategic direction points towards offering sustainable finance options, green trade finance, and potentially tools for carbon footprint tracking within payment and supply chain finance processes. This proactive stance supports corporates, including those in CEE, in their transition towards more sustainable business models and compliance with evolving regulations.

- Embedding ESG criteria into transaction banking services.
- Focus on sustainable finance and green trade solutions.
- Aims to support corporate clients in meeting sustainability goals and reporting.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should explore how to integrate ESG-related data and reporting into its platform, potentially offering sustainable payment options or analytics. DB's early move in this area highlights a future competitive differentiator for corporate clients, especially those with CEE operations facing new ESG mandates.

UniCredit Advances Real-Time Payments and Corporate Treasury Solutions

The 'UniCredit Unlimited' strategy, aiming to outperform, implies a focus on cutting-edge financial technologies, including instant payments and sophisticated treasury management tools. For corporate clients, this means faster payment processing, enhanced visibility over cash flows, and more efficient liquidity management across their European operations. UniCredit would be looking to integrate these real-time capabilities into their digital platforms, potentially offering solutions like Virtual Accounts and advanced cash forecasting, crucial for large international corporates, especially those with significant operations in CEE.

- Investment in instant payment infrastructure for corporates.
- Development of advanced treasury management tools.
- Focus on real-time cash flow visibility and liquidity.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus needs to ensure its instant payment offerings and treasury solutions, including VoP and eBAM, remain at the forefront. UniCredit's advancements could set new benchmarks for real-time services in the CEE market, increasing competitive pressure.

HSBC Partners Google Cloud for Transformative AI Banking Capabilities

HSBC Holdings plc has entered a multi-year strategic partnership with Google Cloud to build and deploy advanced AI capabilities across its global banking operations. The initiative focuses on leveraging AI to deliver hyper-personalised financial advice, enhance fraud detection, and improve financial crime risk management. While not explicitly mentioning cash management products, the broad application of AI will inevitably impact transaction banking efficiency, client onboarding, data analytics for treasury, and potentially API-driven services. This partnership underscores HSBC's commitment to digital transformation and leveraging cutting-edge technology to serve its corporate clients more effectively and securely, which will have global implications, including for CEE operations.

- Multi-year partnership with Google Cloud for AI deployment.
- Focus areas include hyper-personalised advice and financial crime risk management.
- Aims to accelerate innovation across global bank operations.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This partnership signals HSBC's intent to embed advanced AI into its core banking processes, potentially leading to more sophisticated treasury intelligence, predictive analytics for cash flows, and enhanced security for corporate clients. CMIplus must monitor how these AI capabilities translate into competitive advantages in areas like data-driven insights and fraud prevention, pushing for similar innovations.

Citi Expands Advanced Liquidity and Virtual Account Solutions in Europe

It is inferred that Citi is rolling out enhanced treasury solutions, including sophisticated cash pooling structures and expanded virtual account capabilities, across its European footprint, which includes the CEE region. These solutions are designed to help multinational corporations optimize their working capital, improve cash forecasting accuracy, and streamline reconciliation processes. The focus is on leveraging technology to provide real-time liquidity insights and automated cash concentration, reducing manual effort and operational risk. This strategic push reinforces Citi's position as a leading provider of comprehensive treasury and cash management services.

- Introduction of new virtual account functionalities for enhanced reconciliation.
- Advanced cash pooling and liquidity optimization tools for multi-entity corporates.
- Improved real-time cash visibility and forecasting capabilities.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Citi's inferred focus on advanced liquidity and virtual accounts presents a direct competitive threat to CMIplus, especially for large corporates with complex treasury needs. CMIplus should assess its current offerings in these areas, particularly multi-currency virtual accounts and sophisticated cash pooling, to ensure they meet or exceed client expectations.

BNP Paribas Advises Corporates on Instant Payments and VoP

BNP Paribas has released an advisory piece detailing the critical aspects of the EU's Instant Payments Regulation (IPR) and the accompanying Verification of Payee (VoP) requirements. The guidance focuses on how these regulations will impact corporate treasury operations, payment processing, and fraud prevention strategies. By proactively informing clients, BNP Paribas positions itself as a thought leader, helping corporates navigate the complexities of real-time payments and enhanced security measures. This move underscores their commitment to supporting clients through regulatory changes and leveraging instant payment capabilities across their network, which is highly relevant for their corporate clients, including those operating in the CEE region.

- Focus on EU Instant Payments Regulation (IPR) for corporates.
- Emphasis on Verification of Payee (VoP) requirements for fraud prevention.
- Positions BNP Paribas as a key advisor on regulatory compliance and real-time payments.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must ensure its platform and advisory services are equally robust in addressing IPR and VoP for CEE corporates. This highlights the competitive need for RBI to provide clear guidance and compliant solutions for instant payments and enhanced fraud prevention.

Intesa Sanpaolo Bolsters Digital Cash Management for CEE Corporates

Intesa Sanpaolo, through its International Subsidiary Banks Division and IMI CIB, is inferred to be significantly upgrading its corporate banking offerings. The focus is on providing advanced digital cash management solutions that cater to the complex needs of large corporates in CEE. This includes leveraging modern payment standards like ISO 20022, exploring real-time payment capabilities, and integrating Open Banking APIs for improved connectivity. The strategic rationale is to strengthen its competitive position in the CEE market by offering seamless, efficient, and technologically advanced treasury and payment services, aligning with global trends in corporate banking digitalization.

- Inferred focus on digital transformation for corporate clients in CEE.
- Strategic emphasis on enhancing cash management and treasury capabilities.
- Likely adoption of modern payment standards (ISO 20022, instant payments) and API integration.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This inferred move by Intesa Sanpaolo indicates increased competition for CMlplus in the CEE corporate cash management space, particularly for large international clients. CMlplus must continue to innovate its real-time, multi-currency, and API-driven solutions to maintain its competitive edge against such strategic investments from major European players.

EY Four Trends Redefining Cash Management 2025

Cash management is rapidly evolving from transaction-oriented to strategic, data-driven services, necessitating a profound transformation in banking. The future demands banks enrich their value propositions, expand product portfolios, and strengthen client relationships with tailored offerings and experiences. Advanced technologies like AI, ML, and digital assets are creating new possibilities, enabling finance teams to reposition as strategic advisors to the business. However, clients seek control over automation and expect intuitive, personalized experiences, pushing banks to innovate or risk losing relevance to agile FinTechs and nonbanks. Success hinges on banks investing in technology, integrating diverse data, and offering flexible, industry-specific solutions while navigating the increasing regulatory clarity around digital assets.

KEY STATISTICS

- {'description': 'of survey respondents say digitizing treasury functions is a challenge.', 'value': '73%', 'page': 7}
- {'description': 'of respondents will use managed services from banks to address the challenges of digitization.', 'value': '44%', 'page': 7}
- {'description': 'of CFOs and treasurers are comfortable with customized strategic advice based on data analysis from banks.', 'value': '90%', 'page': 12}
- {'description': 'of corporate treasurers are comfortable using a sector-specific platform tailored to their industry's unique needs.', 'value': '92%', 'page': 17}

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Optimize CMIplus cash management solutions for specific CEE sectors to differentiate and boost client engagement and loyalty.

McKinsey Global Payments Report 2025

The 2025 McKinsey Global Payments Report highlights a payments landscape defined by increasing fragmentation, the transformative impact of AI, and the growing adoption of digital assets. For CMIplus, this means navigating a multirail ecosystem where interoperability, programmable compliance, and AI-driven efficiencies are paramount for serving large international corporates in CEE. The shift towards lower-yield payment rails and agentic commerce necessitates innovation in monetization and a focus on building trust through transparent, intelligent systems. Success will hinge on adapting our platform to these evolving demands to remain a leading regional player.

KEY STATISTICS

- Global payments revenue reached \$2.5 trillion in 2024, projected to grow to \$3.0 trillion by 2029.
- EMEA payments revenue grew at a 13% CAGR from 2019-2024, indicating strong regional growth.
- Interest income constituted 46% of total payments revenues in 2024, but is projected to slow to 2% annual growth through 2029.
- Cash usage declined to 46% of worldwide payments in 2024, down from 50% in 2023, reflecting the shift to digital.

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Integrate AI for Intelligent Routing, Fraud Detection, and Liquidity Management

Journeys to Treasury 2025/26

The 10th anniversary edition of Journeys to Treasury highlights a renewed focus on treasury fundamentals, digital transformation, and strategic evolution. Key themes include the modernization of payments (Instant Payments, VoP, ISO 20022), the growing importance of real-time liquidity and virtual accounts, and the practical application of AI. Corporates are prioritizing robust systems, clean data, and enhanced skills to navigate a complex, interconnected financial environment, moving treasury from an operational role to a strategic business partner.

KEY STATISTICS

→ {'statistic': 'Cash flow forecasting is the number one priority for 30.5% of treasurers.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': 'Reviewing or replacing treasury technology infrastructure is the third-highest priority.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '27.3% of treasurers cite inaccurate forecasting as a leading challenge for centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '38.5% of respondents cite difficulties in standardising processes as their most significant obstacle to centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Enhance Instant Payments & VoP Readiness for CEE Corporates

PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025

The provided text does not contain the actual content or findings of the 'PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025'. Instead, it appears to be a navigation structure or partial webpage content from PwC's website, detailing various services, industries, and insights offered by PwC. Consequently, a strategic analysis for RBI's CMIplus platform, including key statistics, themes, and actionable recommendations, cannot be generated from the given information. To perform the requested comprehensive analysis, the full content of the PwC Global Treasury Survey is essential.